



Good THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church
— we seek we serve we celebrate —



BACK TO SCHOOL 2026

Bringing Joy!

Bishop Cedric Bridgeforth (assigned to the Greater Northwest Area) spoke at the Minnesota Annual Conference of the United Methodist Church this June. He preached about the need to bring joy – not to be confused with happiness – to the world. We can see all that is wrong around us and still experience the joy that comes from God and spread joy throughout our communities. That kind of joy, he pointed out, is the root of resistance and justice.

We will be bringing joy this fall – each Sunday we will hear of a Biblical situation of things gone wrong and an example of how we might engage in a spiritual practice that brings joy even in the face of dire situations. Bit by bit, we will learn how to build joy in ourselves and in our communities.

In the midst of all that, we will celebrate our 2025-2026 confirmation class on Sept. 20, and observe World Communion Sunday on October 4.

September 6

Psalm 13
“Destruction and Faith”

September 13

Rally Sunday
Exodus 14:19-31; Matthew 18:21-35
“Bring Joy by Praying for Your Enemies”

September 20

Confirmation Sunday
Exodus 16:2-15; Matthew 20:1-16
“Bring Joy by Living Generously”

September 27

Exodus 17:1-7; Matthew 21:23-32
“Bring Joy by Trusting in God”

October 4

World Communion Sunday
Communion
Exodus 20:1-4, 7-9, 12-20
“Bring Joy Through Worship”

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Rally Day!

Our kick off to the program year is Sunday, September 13:

- ★ Worship service at 10:00, outside, with a blessing of bags and backpacks.
- ★ Grilled lunch – the youth will be selling lunch options of hot dogs, burgers, veggie burgers and salads following worship.
- ★ Lawn games, sidewalk chalk, bubbles
- ★ Fellowship – greet long-time friends, make new acquaintances, hang around to chat, eat, and join in the games following worship.

Rally Sunday

SEPT. 13

WORSHIP AT 10AM



PLUS:

- BLESSING OF THE BACKPACKS
- SUNDAY SCHOOL OPEN HOUSE
- \$5 LUNCH SERVED BY YOUTH
- LAWN GAMES, GIANT BUBBLES & SIDEWALK CHALK



United
Women
in Faith

United Women in Faith

News from Your United Women in Faith, Sept. 2026

Yes, the rummage sale in June was a success; held at the same time as the garage sales in Nokomis East neighborhood, we had a good turnout for the 2 ½ day event. After expenses, we had a grand total of \$3,496.41 which was split between our treasury and that of Minnehaha UMC. Also, many of you were able to get rid of lots of rummage! Great thanks to those who volunteered: Char Johnson, Kim Kanuit, Margaret Rawson, Jenny Ammerman, Annette Meier, Gene Thompson, Chuck Kanuit, Shirley Arms, Diane and Bob Enge, John Hayden, Linda Duncan, Calvin Emrick, Ann, Elliott and Malcolm Gliddon, Cory Dallas, Scott Gruenhagen, Gail, Beth and Phyllis Minchart, Jan Moren, Jen Johnson, Jan Hughes, Sharon Shimomura, Craig Johnson, Eli Nehus, Susan Delattre, Sarah Selvig, Julie Darlington, Kristine Danzinger, Barb Matz, Susan Corrado, Paula Barton, Sean Kennedy-Heldt, Steve Meier and Maureen Trepp. Several people helped every single day, including prepping.

We also served at three funerals this summer: Barb Spleiss, Andree Papenhausen and Bonnie Graham. This service for the families has been a joy to them and can be a lot of work but is also very rewarding. The income for the receptions goes into our treasury to go on to the missions we support.

We continue to serve meals at the new Simpson Shelter during the last week of the month. It only takes 6 of us to prep meals under the direction of the chef employed by Simpson. Upcoming dates are Sept. 28, Oct. 27, Nov. 23 and Dec. 28. If you are interested in helping, we need to preregister and we begin at 5:00. Please contact Maureen Trepp at 612-387-2520

There is an informative and interesting magazine that is published for United Women in Faith called "Response" and tells about the many missions that our international organization supports. It is in the library next to the chapel and available to be read by anyone! Please check it out.

Start making, baking, sewing, carving, arranging those crafts you would like to sell at our annual Holiday Bazaar! It will be Sat., Nov. 14 from 9:00-2:00 with vendor tables to rent, food to eat, a Granny's Attic with jewelry and great valuable stuff. We can always use volunteers so be ready to volunteer! Set up is the day before, Nov. 13.

Know that your existence calls for celebration every day!

Peace, Maureen Trepp, *UWF President*



MINNEHAHA PLAYERS MUSIC & DRAMA CAMP 2026







2026 Graduates

Youth Group

Our youth group for 6th-12th graders kicks-off on Sunday, Sept. 20. Youth Group meets most Sundays from 4:00-5:30 pm.



Family Fun Night at Nokomis Beach





Middle School Mission Trip 2026

Middle School Mission Trip

Our middle school youth teamed up with the youth of Love First UMC, St. Cloud for a mini-mission trip partnering with Interfaith Action of Greater St. Paul. With the theme of Who is Your Neighbor? the youth helped Interfaith Action continue to transform a former hotel in St. Paul into a place that houses families as they transition to permanent housing, a food shelf, and office spaces. This included carrying out hotel room furniture, sorting donations, and painting four rooms.

All the personal hygiene products & school supplies donated by our church were deeply appreciated. Thank you



High School Mission Trip

In July, our high school youth teamed up with Love First UMC, St. Cloud and served around the Twin Cities. These projects included: assembling 10 dressers for Bridging, creating greeting cards for our churches' homebound members, spray painting "Keep 'em Clean, Drains to River" stencils near storm drains around St. Paul with Friends of the Mississippi River, sorting and hanging donated clothing to sell at Arc's Value Village Thrift Store, taking apart old computers for recycling at MN Tech for Success, and assembling backpacks with school supplies with the Kids in Need Foundation. The group concluded their service week with a fun day at Valleyfair!

Wednesday Night Dinners

Our Wednesday night meals return indoors starting on Sept. 9th.



Blessing of the bikes, bike helmets, scooters



Bible Study: Confirmation for Adults

Ever wanted to take confirmation again, now that you are an adult? Or, maybe you didn't do confirmation. Or, maybe you are like me and you don't really remember anything from your confirmation class. No matter your confirmation class story, I'll be offering a confirmation class for adults! We'll study the same topics as our 9th graders, but from an adult perspective. Classes don't require any preparation, and they will be on Monday evenings at 6:30 p.m. We will also offer a hybrid option, so look for a zoom link in the enews. Classes start on Monday, September 21 with a survey tour of the Bible. The whole thing! A little preface for context, and then one section a week through November 9. We'll take a break for an Advent study led by Rev. Gail Alexander, and then resume with more topics in January.

Stewardship

We'll have more information in the next newsletter, but just to let you all know that our Stewardship Campaign will be starting in October this year. We are hoping to get an earlier start on planning the income side of our 2027 budget.



Summer Pick Up Choir

Artificial Intelligence and United Methodist Church's Social Principles

Join us for an adult faith formation series on Pope Leo XIV's encyclical on AI, *Magnifica Humanitatis!* Led by John Davis on Sunday mornings from 10:45-11:30 a.m.

Week 1 (September 20): An introduction to Artificial Intelligence basics so everyone starts on the same page, followed by an overview of the papal text.

Weeks 2–7: Each week, we'll dive into a single chapter, exploring human dignity, digital ethics, the common good, and remaining profoundly human in a tech-driven world.

Discover how the United Methodist Church's Social Principles guide our relationship with modern technology. We have 19 copies of the book available for participants!



Save the Date: Pasta Fundraising Dinner

Join us for a night of pasta, community, and supporting a great cause!

Thursday, October 22, 5:30–7:30 p.m.
New Branches, 5011 31st Avenue
South, Minneapolis

Tickets: \$32 (\$37 after October 17) ·
Kids age 5 and under eat free
Ticket sales open soon — watch for
details!



MinneHarvest

Our free food give-away once a month is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. We gather outside on the 4th Saturday of each month; join us on September 26 for all or any portion of that time, dress appropriately for the weather, and bring a friend! You can volunteer anytime between 7:00 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up around 7:00, serve the food starting around 8:00, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30.

MINNEHARVEST
a food mission of minnehaha united methodist church

SNAP Sunday — October 11

SNAP (Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program, formerly food stamps) is changing. New eligibility rules mean the Minnesota Department of Children, Youth and Families expects roughly a third of the state's SNAP recipients to lose their benefits altogether, while those who remain enrolled will receive less help each month.

This isn't an abstract policy shift — it's about our neighbors. Right now, 100,238 people in Hennepin County rely on SNAP to help feed their families. As benefits shrink, many will turn to food shelves like Minnehaha Food Shelf to fill the gap.

That's why our seven sponsoring congregations are joining together on Sunday, October 11 for "SNAP Sunday" — a day of giving to help us meet a goal of \$4,000, the average weekly cost of keeping our shelves stocked with fresh, nutritious food.

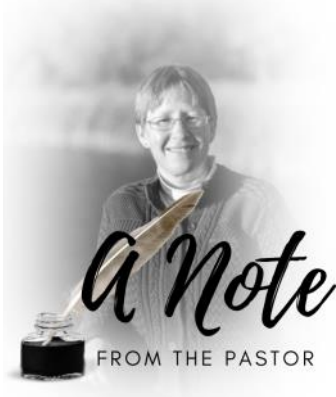
You can help by giving through a special offering that day, or anytime, at our secure online donation page:

<https://bit.ly/3JCzVDT>

Every gift helps make sure our neighbors don't go hungry.



130+ backpacks were distributed at the August MinneHarvest



Spiritual Practices

One of the founders of the United Methodist Church, John Wesley, talked a lot about the various ways we can build a relationship with God. He gathered people together in small groups and encouraged them to check in with each other, pray together, read the Bible together, and sing together. And those are just some of the ways he thought we could live out our faith. He wrote that the list was endless. It includes predictable things like the things mentioned above and worship, but also included things like caring for our communities and engaging in acts of justice. He knew that people were all different from each other, and that each of us had different ways in which we felt close to God. It might be gardening or protesting or organizing your block club. It might be volunteering at the food shelf, tutoring a student, or making cookies with someone. Wesley did not create a limited list, indicating that the possibilities were endless. I invite you to find what is on your list. What things help to strengthen your relationship to God? What things challenge you to listen more closely to where God is leading you? What things give you a sense of peace when your soul needs to rest in deep waters? And then make sure you are finding regular time to engage in those spiritual practices.

With Joy,

Becky



Baptisms of Bryn, Hank, and Ivy!





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